

AV1769 vs PCE

including comparisons to 1769 & 1774 Oxford editions, Blayney revisions

The PCE was supposedly created to correct issues in the “KJV 1769 Oxford Edition – revision by Blayney”. I could find no official statement from Cambridge or otherwise as to the intended purpose of their revisions. I could also find no official or unofficial statement about which exact version of the 1769 Oxford edition the PCE was supposedly intended to correct.

The KJV 1769 Oxford edition (Blayney) scan was obtained from:

<https://archive.org/details/kjv-1769-oxford-edition-full-bible>

The KJV 1774 Oxford edition (Blayney) scan was obtained from:

<https://archive.org/details/kjv-1769-oxford-edition-blayney-1774>

PDF Scan (1769):

O X F O R D,
Printed by *T. Wright* and *W. Gill*, Printers to the UNIVERSITY:
And sold by *R. Baldwin*, and *S. Crowder*, in Paternoster Row, London;
and by *W. Jackson*, in Oxford. 1769.
CUM PRIVILEGIO.

Printed book (1769):

O X F O R D,
Printed by *T. Wright* and *W. Gill*, Printers to the UNIVERSITY:
And sold by *R. Baldwin*, and *S. Crowder*, in Paternoster Row, London;
and by *W. Jackson*, in Oxford. 1769.
CUM PRIVILEGIO.

PDF Scan (1774):

O X F O R D,
Printed by **T. WRIGHT** and **W. GILL**,
Printers to the UNIVERSITY:
And Sold by **S. CROWDER**, Paternoster Row, London;
And by **W. JACKSON**, in Oxford. 1774.
CUM PRIVILEGIO.

Quote from Bibleprotector.com about the PCE:

The Authorized King James Version of the Holy Bible is God's providentially appointed Word for the whole world which reveals the name of the Father as "Jehovah", and the name of His Son, "Jesus", in whom there is salvation, and the name of the "Holy Ghost", who also manifests Himself in true traditional Pentecostalism.

The standard text of the Pure Cambridge Edition of the King James Bible has been published on this website. You are free to download this definitive electronic text of the King James Bible (KJB). The actual King James Bible text of the Pure Cambridge Edition (PCE) has been presented free of any typographical error, and is completely correct. It is scrupulously exact in typesetting right down to the italics and punctuation.

This precise edition of the King James Bible is wholly based on the received traditional text as was published by Cambridge University Press and by Collins publishers. This electronic text has been made in Australia for the purpose of the exaltation of the Bible within Australasia. This Word is necessary for true Pentecostal revival throughout the whole Earth. The English Bible has been providentially raised up by God for a great dissemination of the true Gospel.

The Pure Cambridge Edition (first published circa 1900) is the product of the process of textual purification that has occurred since 1611 when the Authorized Version was completed, and has been used (often unwittingly) as the received text for many decades. Millions of copies conformed to this edition were issued by Bible and missionary societies in the twentieth century. This text stands in contrast to all other editions (especially newly edited and modernised ones). The providentially established and correct text has, among other things, "Geba" not "Gaba" at Ezra 2:26.

Psalms 12:6

The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.

Note that "are" is present tense (it's perpetually a finished thing) and that "as" is similar to "like". None of these tell us that the word of God needs to undergo any sort of purification process. In fact the opposite, it is perpetually and always pure.

If God's word needed a "purification" process that itself implies that it was not pure to begin with. If one would argue that the text itself is what needed purified – then that text could not have been God's word to begin with. If you think carefully, a word cannot be both God's word and also need purified/fixed at the same time. If it's God's word, then it's pure. If it isn't pure, it isn't God's word.

So, then what is this textual purification process? Let's take God's council and God's command and put them together: **Matthew 7:16a**, **1Thess 5:21**.

Quote from several web sites that claim this is how to verify if you have a PCE (note that those same web sites also state that even amongst those revisions that are called PCE there are variations):

Pure Cambridge edition checklist:

The Pure Cambridge Edition is the title given to the 1900 edition of the King James Version.

Use this checklist to ascertain whether the Bible is a Cambridge Edition:

- 1) "or Sheba" not "and Sheba" in Joshua 19:2
- 2) "sin" not "sins" in 2 Chronicles 33:19
- 3) "Spirit of God" not "spirit of God" in Job 33:4
- 4) "whom ye" not "whom he" in Jeremiah 34:16
- 5) "Spirit of God" not "spirit of God" in Ezekiel 11:24
- 6) "flieth" not "fleeth" in Nahum 3:16
- 7) "Spirit" not "spirit" in Matthew 4:1
- 8) "further" not "farther" in Matthew 26:39
- 9) "bewrayeth" not "betrayeth" in Matthew 26:73
- 10) "Spirit" not "spirit" in Mark 1:12
- 11) "spirit" not "Spirit" in Acts 11:28
- 12) "spirit" not "Spirit" in 1 John 5:8

Along with this list are also:

Ezra 2:26 The Pure Cambridge Edition 1900 has "Geba" not "Gaba"

Highlight = Modern 1769 rendition

Ok, so let's have a look at the PCE and see how it compares to the 1769 Oxford Blayney and also a "standard" printed and a digital AV1769 using the checklist that is provided.

		Difference from 1769 Oxford		
Verse	1769 Oxford, Blayney	AV1769	1774 Oxford, Blayney	PCE
Joshua 19:2	2 And ^{they} had in their inheritance Beer-sheba, Sheba, and Moladah, "Sheba"	"or Sheba"	2 And they had in their inheritance, Beer-sheba, and Sheba, and Moladah, "and Sheba"	"or Sheba" (claims the 1769 uses "and Sheba")
2 Chronicles 33:19	19 His prayer also, and how God was intreated of him, and all his sins, and his trespasss, and the places wherein he built high places, and set up groves and graven images, before he was humbled: behold, they are written among the sayings of the seers. "sins"	"sin"	19 His prayer also, and how God was intreated of him, and all his sin, and his trespasss, and the places wherein he built high places, and set up groves, and graven images, before he was humbled: behold, they are written among the sayings of the seers. "sin"	"sin"
Job 33:4	4 The Spirit of God hath made me, and the breath of the Almighty hath given me life. "Spirit of God"	None	utter knowledge clearly. 4 The spirit of God hath made me, and the breath of the Almighty hath given me life. "spirit of God"	None (claims the 1769 uses "spirit")
Jeremiah 34:16	16 But ye turned and ^{polluted} my name, and caused every man his servant, and every man his handmaid, whom he had set at liberty at their pleasure, to return, and brought them into subjection, to be unto you for servants and for handmaids. "whom he"	"whom ye"	is called by my name. 16 But ye turned and polluted my name, and caused every man his servant, and every man his handmaid, whom he had set at liberty at their pleasure, to return, and brought them into subjection, to be unto you for servants and for handmaids. None	"whom ye"
Ezekiel 11:24	24 ¶ Afterwards ^{the} spirit took me up, and brought me in a vision by the Spirit of God into Chaldea, to them of the captivity. So the vision that I had seen went up from me. "Spirit of God"	None	24 ¶ Afterwards the spirit took me up, and brought me in vision by the spirit of God into Chaldea, to them of the captivity: so the vision that I had seen went up from me. "spirit of God"	None (claims the 1769 uses "spirit of God")
Nahum 3:16	16 Thou hast multiplied thy merchants above the stars of heaven: the cankerworm spoileth, and fleeth away. "fleeth away"	"flieth away"	have thyself many as the locusts. 16 Thou hast multiplied thy merchants above the stars of heaven: the cankerworm spoileth and fleeth away. "fleeth away"	"flieth away"

Matthew 4:1	THEN was ^{Jesus} led up of ^{the} spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil. "spirit"	"Spirit"	<i>Christ's fasting and temptation.</i> THEN was Jesus led up of the spirit into the wilderness, to be tempted of the devil. "spirit"	"Spirit"
Matthew 26:39	39 And he went a little farther, and fell on his face, and prayed, saying, " O my Father, if it be possible, " let this cup pass from me: nevertheless " not as I will, but as thou <i>wilt</i>. "farther"	"further"	with me. 39 And he went a little farther, and fell on his face, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if it be possible, let this cup pass from me: nevertheless, not as I will, but as thou <i>wilt</i>. 40 And he cometh unto the same. "farther"	"further"
Matthew 26:73	73 And after a while came unto <i>him</i> they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art <i>one</i> of them; for thy ^{own} speech bewrayeth thee. "bewrayeth"	None	oath, I do not know the man. 73 And after a while came unto him they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art <i>one</i> of them, for thy speech bewrayeth thee. "bewrayeth"	None (claims the 1769 uses "betrayeth")
Mark 1:12	12 ¶ And immediately the spirit driveth him into the wilderness. "spirit"	"Spirit"	12 ¶ And immediately the Spirit driveth him into the wilderness. "Spirit"	"Spirit"
Acts 11:28	28 And there stood up one of them named Agabus, and signified by the spirit that there should be great dearth throughout all. "spirit"	"Spirit"	28 And there stood up one of them named Agabus, and signified by the spirit, that there should be great dearth throughout all the world: which came to pass in the days of Claudius Cesar. "spirit"	None (claims the 1769 uses "Spirit")
1 John 5:8	8 And there are three that bear witness in earth, the spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one. "spirit"	"Spirit"	8 And there are three that bear witness in earth, the spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one. "spirit"	None (claims the 1769 uses "Spirit")
Ezra 2:26	26 The children of Ramah and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one. "Gaba"	None	26 The children of Ramah, and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one. "Gaba"	"Geba"

So it appears that some of the changes they claimed to have “purified” weren’t needed at all? It also isn’t clear from these two samples which edition of the Oxford printing that they were even attempting to correct. Let’s give them the benefit of the doubt and assume that we aren’t looking at the same Oxford, Blayney edition that they were.

Let’s have a careful look at what they don’t tell us:

“Most” modern 1769 Bibles have none of the “problems” listed in the checklist. Check your non-PCE KJV Bible and see for yourself. Additionally, I’ve noticed that rarely, some “modern” printed and digital KJVs (that are not explicitly called PCE) have some but not all of the differences that the PCE has.

But there is one thing that we did not verify ([1Thess 5:21](#)) yet and that is what are all the differences that the PCE has? Are they all on that checklist that we are provided? The answer, as you will see below and you can verify for yourself, is most assuredly no. So, why aren’t some of the differences listed ... anywhere? Why are we only given a subset of what is actually different? Was this “purification” process of so little importance to them that they didn’t even bother to document all of the changes they made?

Every single change, no matter how seemingly minor, carries a heavy burden with it:

Because this is God’s word we’re talking about. Changing it is not like changing any other body of text. Adding to it or taking away from it in any way without direct consent of the Holy Ghost comes with severe consequences: [Deuteronomy 4:2](#), [12:32](#), [Revelation 22:18,19](#). And so we can learn from God’s word itself that every single unauthorized change carries with it the second death sentence.

In addition to that, if you weren’t aware, changing a single punctuation mark can completely change an interpretation or a doctrine.

Let’s do a comparison between a digital AV1769 (verified against a printed one) and a digital PCE from Bibleprotector.com which claims to be a definitive source for preserving the PCE. Note that this is not the only PCE edition that has these “additional” differences. From what I’ve checked so far, they all have them.

NOTE: The cover for PCE editions appears to be “King James Bible” whereas most authentic 1611-1769 “KJV” Bibles use “Holy Bible” or “The Holy Bible”. The use of the phrase “King James Bible” did not come into common usage until around the early 19th century. Moreover, the titles on the covers are seemingly mixed between editions and so it’s no longer possible to identify one from the other based on just the cover text.

Here are the remaining differences in the PCE that they don't tell us about (this does not include whole-word capitalization differences, Psalm superscripts, epistle colophons, pilcrows, or seemingly minor formatting differences):

- “and the Hivites” not “the Hivites” in [Exodus 23:23](#)
- “his hand that smote us;” not “his hand that smote us.” in [1 Samuel 6:9](#)
- “ye shall not prosper?” not “ye shall not prosper.” in [Jeremiah 32:5](#)
- “into Capernaum, after” not “into Capernaum after” in [Mark 2:1](#)
- “spirit” not “Spirit” in [Acts 11:12](#)
- “father of many nations;” not “father of many nations.” in [Romans 4:18](#)
- “But when he saith, all” not “But when he saith all” in [1 Corinthians 15:27](#)

Remember that claim above that the PCE is “free of any typographical error”? What’s that question mark at the end of [Jeremiah 32:5](#)? Why was the “S” in “Spirit” made lowercase in [Acts 11:12](#) without telling anyone?

Verify these differences for yourself, and have a close look at each one in their context, and then decide for yourself if they make sense.